



End of an era?

Dodge offers a throwback - unveils the Viper ACR
<http://dgit.in/1LdA36s>



Google could be our Skynet

Elon Musk feels that Google could one day build robots that might be the downfall of humanity.
<http://dgit.in/1EesWVm>



Karbonn Titanium MACH TWO

the perfect time for us to do this comparison. The budget and affordable smartphone segments have had their fill of devices in the last few months and you have a wide range to choose from now, ensuring you get the best bang for your buck. So, off we went, contacting the companies and getting some of the best budget and affordable smartphones out there.

This is a battle between the big guns from the sub-7k and sub-15k smartphone segments.

BUILD AND DESIGN

There's a lot of merit to the build and design department of a smartphone. The looks of a smartphone and how well it is built are the first things that attract a customer, so it better

be good. For an OEM, it is very important to get things right.

Four phones stood out in this department - the Yu Yuphoria, Xiaomi Mi4i, Asus Zenfone 2 and the BlackBerry Z3. In terms of pure looks, we lean towards the Mi4i, although the Yuphoria is a very good looking smartphone for its price range. The Asus Zenfone 2 does well with the brushed metal finish on its back, but the looks aren't quite good enough to outdo the Xiaomi Mi4i.

Even in terms of the overall seamlessness of the design and build quality, Xiaomi outperforms the others. The Yuphoria has a metal frame, which is good for a budget device, but it isn't as sturdy as the Mi4i or the Zenfone 2.

Speaking of sturdiness, that's one area where the BlackBerry Z3 outdoes all the other smartphones.

The two Karbonn phones are also pretty well built. In fact, the Titanium Mach One and Mach Two are quite literally design knock-offs of the Apple iPhone 6 and iPhone 5S respectively. Of course, they aren't built using premium materials and feel rather flimsy and opposite of Apple's iPhones.

DISPLAY

If you're buying a sub-7k smartphone and the display is your priority, then you can't go wrong with the Xiaomi Redmi 2. The Yu Yuphoria and Lenovo A6000 Plus have good displays, but they can't hold a candle against Xiaomi. The Moto E 4G on the other hand loses out to all its competitors. It is just not sharp enough to matter in the display department.

The best display out of the eight smartphones taken into consideration though has to be given to the Xiaomi Mi4i. The wide viewing angles combined with really accurate colour reproduction won us over. If that wasn't enough, the Mi4i's 1080p display also feels really nice and premium and doesn't get smudged with fingerprints at all.

The Asus Zenfone 2 also has a pretty nice 1080p 5.5 inch display, but it is neither as bright as the Mi4i, nor as sharp.

PERFORMANCE

This one came out exactly as we expected it to be. The Asus Zenfone 2 was the runaway winner in the performance department. The Intel Atom Z3560 quad-core processor clocked at 1.8GHz performs well above what the Xiaomi

Mi4i can achieve. The Zenfone 2 doesn't just handle multi-tasking and resource intensive applications easily, but offers very good GPU performance. In case you're wondering, the phone has a PowerVR G6430



GPU, which is what the Apple iPhone 5S also uses.

The Zenfone 2's performance may not be the same as the iPhone, but it's enough to edge out all the other devices in this comparison. On benchmarks, the Zenfone 2 clocks above 40,000 on AnTuTu, while GFXBench's Manhattan Onscreen test clocks around



Motorola Moto E